Apex Systems

Cloud-native claims engineering for regulated industries

Response to RFP-2026-017: Digital Claims Processing Platform for Meridian Insurance Group (fictional)

Submitted: 2026-10-12. This is a fictional document created for a classroom project.

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Meridian Insurance Group needs to reduce average claim handling time from 11 days to under 5 days while integrating with its policy administration system, payment gateway and document archive. Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native claims platform built on a microservice architecture, designed for regulated insurers that must demonstrate control over every claim decision.

We understand that Meridian expects 3 million claim transactions per year, seasonal peaks of up to four times normal volume, and strict auditability of every automated decision.

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Architecture

The platform runs as containerised microservices on Kubernetes with an event-driven backbone built on Kafka. A REST API and a GraphQL gateway expose every function to Meridian's channels. Pre-built connectors cover common policy administration systems, and a legacy MQ adapter will connect the existing mainframe policy system without changes on the mainframe side.

The design is multi-region with automatic failover and high availability of 99.95 percent. Autoscaling policies add capacity during claim peaks, and the platform was load tested at 5,000 transactions per second. A sandbox environment is available from week 4 so that Meridian's teams can test integrations early. Single sign-on is provided through SAML with Meridian's identity provider.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

Delivery takes 9 months in three phases: Discovery and design (weeks 1-8), Build (weeks 9-28) and User acceptance testing and go-live (weeks 29-38). Key milestones are design sign-off (week 8), integration complete (week 24) and go-live (week 38).

The team consists of one project manager, one solution architect, six engineers and one QA lead. Key risk: legacy data quality, mitigated through a data profiling exercise in the discovery phase.

4. Pricing and Assumptions

Item	Price (USD)
Platform licence and build	1,150,000
Integration and connectors	180,000
Training	40,000
Year 1 support (business hours)	110,000
TOTAL (fixed price)	**1,480,000**

Assumptions:

- Fixed price for the scope described; payment 30% / 40% / 30% at milestones.
- Data migration is limited to two source systems.
- 24x7 support add-on is not included in the total.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex Systems is ISO 27001 certified and holds a SOC 2 Type II report, available under NDA. Data is encrypted with AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit. Multi-factor authentication and role-based access control (RBAC) enforce least privilege, and all claim decisions are written to immutable audit logs retained for seven years.

An independent penetration test is performed every year and after every major release; vulnerability scans run weekly. We provide a GDPR data protection impact assessment (DPIA) template, data residency inside Meridian's region, and an incident response plan with notification within four hours.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Standard support is business hours (8x5) with a four business hour response time. 24x7 coverage is available as an optional add-on. Apex has delivered six insurance deployments in the past five years.

References: Northbridge Mutual (fictional) and Castle Re (fictional); contact details on request.